

terminal prompt. Whenever you see the `python` command in this book, enter `python3` instead.

You'll need Python 3.9 or later to run the code in this book. If the Python version installed on your system is earlier than Python 3.9, or if you want to update to the latest version currently available, refer to the instructions in Appendix A.

Running Python in a Terminal Session

You can try running snippets of Python code by opening a terminal and entering `python3`, as you did when checking your version. Do this again, and when you have Python running, enter the following line in the terminal session:

```
>>> print("Hello Python interpreter!")
Hello Python interpreter!
>>>
```

The message should print directly in the current terminal window. Remember that you can close the Python interpreter by pressing CTRL-D or by entering the command `exit()`.

Installing VS Code

On Ubuntu Linux, you can install VS Code from the Ubuntu Software Center. Click the Ubuntu Software icon in your menu and search for *vscode*. Click the app called **Visual Studio Code** (sometimes called *code*), and then click **Install**. Once it's installed, search your system for *VS Code* and launch the app.

Running a Hello World Program

With a recent version of Python and VS Code installed, you're almost ready to run your first Python program written in a text editor. But before doing so, you need to install the Python extension for VS Code.

Installing the Python Extension for VS Code

VS Code works with many different programming languages; to get the most out of it as a Python programmer, you'll need to install the Python extension. This extension adds support for writing, editing, and running Python programs.

To install the Python extension, click the Manage icon, which looks like a gear in the lower-left corner of the VS Code app. In the menu that appears, click **Extensions**. Enter `python` in the search box and click the **Python** extension. (If you see more than one extension named *Python*, choose the one supplied by Microsoft.) Click **Install** and install any additional tools that your system needs to complete the installation. If you see a message that you need to install Python, and you've already done so, you can ignore this message.